

## One Toyota Business Glossary – Tips and Notes

Use the **TERMS** tab of the Business Glossary Template to add or update terms and definitions. All other tabs on the template are for reference only. They will be updated by the EDC/Axon Admin Team when necessary.

When creating terms and definitions...

- Terms should be defined in a system agnostic manner (i.e. at the enterprise level) whenever possible.
- The glossary should service the needs of the novice, intermediate, and expert audience.
  - The terms and definitions in the glossary should make sense to the enterprise user with no working knowledge of the domain, application, term, etc.
- Multiple physical attributes (table and column, data set and field, report, dashboard, etc.) can in turn be linked to the same Glossary terms to show that they are manifestations of the concept in use somewhere in the organization.
- A primary purpose of the glossary is to help users understand the definition and application of individual concepts (terms), so that the user knows where its usage and purpose is relevant.
- Without compromising the definition, it should be as brief as possible.
- Clarifying what it a term is NOT can be a powerful element of the definition, especially where common misconceptions are known/expected.
- An enterprise glossary should ideally have the following characteristics:
  - Clear and Unambiguous
    - A collection of well described entries that help users understand meaning and application.
  - A glossary is no place for heavy use of jargon/technical language
    - This has its place for those that understand it, but will always be a barrier to engagement for the majority of those that don't.
  - Usable
    - Easy to get value from, intuitive to search, read and use.
  - Unique
    - Duplicate terms cause confusion - which is the right one to choose?
    - You may find situations where the same term is used in different areas to mean totally different things.
    - Such instances need to be exposed and contrasted so users clearly understand when they can/cannot use each term.
    - Even where the duplication seeks to show the same definition applies in another context, this can be confusing.
  - Information about technical joins and technical relationships is rarely suitable for an enterprise glossary
    - Whilst invaluable to technical users supporting the business community these terms rarely mean anything to business users.
    - Including them can add a lot of unnecessary content to the glossary.
    - This can often be a barrier to adoption – such content scares people off!
  - Disambiguate literal duplicates (same name, totally different things)

- Where you find these, do what you can to help users understand the right way to go.
- Ensuring a good description is a good start, but persisting literal duplicates that reference different concepts is not supportable in the longer term.
- Add a prefix or suffix to each name, for now, to help clarify.
- Maybe now is the time to adopt clearer names and break from existing practices for the greater good?
- Creating two separate definitions (for the same term) that appease different communities is not a good solution
  - Where users are presented with two possibilities, relationships will be made inconsistently between each, and user confusion will not help adoption of the Glossary.
  - You also lose one of the key benefits of aligning everything to one term - getting enterprise visibility of all activities that are supported/relevant to this concept.
- When all contributors relate their assets to the same central glossary objects, we will quickly build up a holistic view of how the same concepts are applied in different parts of our organization.
- Multiple entries will inevitably occur, we need to work together to minimize them and determine the best way to unite the descriptions, when discovered.
- Use of the Alias feature in Axon will allow us to create and maintain one definition, and record all recognized names for the concept.
  - Current functionality in both Unison Search and Quick Search allows users to search for the term they recognize, but for the 'official' name of the term to be returned.
- Characteristics of good Glossary definitions
  - Brief and to the point.
  - Wordy definitions may raise more questions than they answer (assuming that users can even be bothered to read them).
  - Unambiguous. Definitions need precision: state what is covered, and what is not.
  - Clear about the use and the purpose.
  - Written to define the concept rather than just the word.
  - May reference other concepts where necessary to provide context.
  - Use an absolute minimum of jargon/technical terms, abbreviations and acronyms.
    - All acronyms should be spelled out the first time they are used in a definition.
    - Acronyms should have their own Glossary entry and definition that at a minimum is what the letters stand for (e.g. PASA – Parts and After Sales Analytics).
    - This especially applies to Toyota specific acronyms (acronyms not found in a standard English Dictionary (e.g. The Oxford English Dictionary)).
  - Able to avoid using the term that is being defined.
  - Practical - offer examples (in the example field, not as part of the definition unless necessary).
  - Professional sounding
    - Proper grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
    - Consistent use of past and present tense and singular and plural cases.
    - No missing articles (a, the, it, etc.).

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Simply put, anyone should be able to get value from the glossary. If they can't, they'll visit a couple of times, and then revert to whatever they used to do.